

Record Keeping

Record keeping is the process of keeping information about something for the purpose of preserving/keeping it for future use. The information can be stored in a written form or in an electronic system for future reference.

ITEMS IN KEEPING RECORDS

1. Personal diary
2. Files
3. Electronic system e.g. computer, phones, disc, recorded tapes etc.
4. Books e.g school attendance book for staff
5. Log book: This book contains records of certain events or activities that happened in the school.
6. School diary for scheme of works and after work done
7. Class registers for students attendance to school.
8. Dossiers: for students results
9. Visitors book: for important visitors
10. Black book/punishment book
11. Hospital folders
12. Minutes book on proceedings of meetings etc.

Reasons for keeping records

1. Records are kept for reference purpose
2. Records are kept in order not to forget them easily
3. Records are kept for future clarifications e.g school fees receipt
4. It makes one not to get into trouble.
5. It is used for interviews or for job purposes.
6. It shows that the keeper is careful, trustworthy and responsible
7. Record keeping shows a good mark on someone's personality.

Where and how records should be kept

Records should be kept in orderly manner and in a safe place. E.g a big envelope with a title or name written on it. Records are kept where they can be easily found. They are also written in brief, concise and accurate manner.

Exercise

- a. What is record keeping?
- b. Give five reasons why records are kept
- c. Mention six items for keeping records.
- d. Why do you keep personal records?

Assignment

Get a small diary, keep records of your activities for two weeks and submit on a scheduled date.